

The psychology of spending

The first three months of the savings plan, for me, were the hardest. I was like a teenager crushing over One Direction; when the object of my affection was out of my reach I became frustrated. My father says that seeing me adjust to the plan was like watching a recently caught shark thrashing about. It felt like that on the inside.

I was renting just off one of Melbourne's best shopping strips, where local lovelies sashay in \$400 frocks. For me to live there was dangerous. By living on only the pocket money in my wallet, all I could do was window-shop. But the pointlessness turned to boredom and, in a few months, the cravings disappeared.

The Pocket Money Savings Plan is an aggressive correction to your personal finances, and the hit you'll take to your lifestyle may be a challenge to adjust to. Happy hours at bars will become your paradise. As will cooking at home then going out for coffee and dessert. And brunch is a *once-a-week* affair. You get the drill. If you want to tighten your belt, there are other ways to bump your savings without sacrificing life's simple pleasures, and it comes down to the mindset of spending.

Try a #nofilter life

When I began the fashion editor phase of my journalism career, Instagram was only a pixel of an idea. Traditional glossy magazines were the preserve of labels of the moment, which made them aspirational but unattainable. Claudia Schiffer in a \$3000 dress, shot by Mario Testino, had the air of the impossible.

These days, the temptations are closer to home, and rooted in reality. Brands with even a minimal marketing spend can target a blogger with tens of thousands of followers by gifting them an outfit in exchange for a gushing post. For example, meet Jaxson. He's a wellness blogger and social